

Basketweaver — User Manual

Basketweaver is a real-time timing overlay for EverQuest weapon-weaving. It draws a scrolling highway showing when to swap to your offhand weapon set so your offhand round lands without clipping your mainhand swing timer.

Combat events can be read two ways: from your **EQ log file** (default), or directly from the game via a **Zeal named pipe** if you are running the Zeal client plugin. Both modes produce identical overlays — the difference is only in how data reaches Basketweaver.

Table of Contents

1. [How It Works](#)
 2. [Core Concepts & Definitions](#)
 3. [First-Time Setup](#)
 4. [Zeal Pipe Tracking](#)
 5. [Understanding the Overlay](#)
 6. [Timing Your Weaves](#)
 7. [Calibration](#)
 8. [Tray Menu Reference](#)
 9. [Keyboard Shortcuts](#)
 10. [Troubleshooting](#)
-

1. How It Works

The Weaving Technique

The weaving technique is viable for any class that has dual wield and access to strong 2H weapons. The objective is to get a free "bonus" swing with an offhand weapon in between 2H weapon swings. This works because dual wield runs on an independent timer from your mainhand, and your primary weapon swing timer is not reset when you swap weapon sets.

Done well, weaving has the potential to add approximately 20–30 DPS to a raid target over standard 2H weapon DPS.

The challenge is timing: if you do not swap your weapon set back to your 2H setup before the mainhand timer resets, you will clip your attack — or swing a 1H weapon instead of your high-impact 2H weapon. This is called a **clip**, and it costs more DPS than not weaving at all.

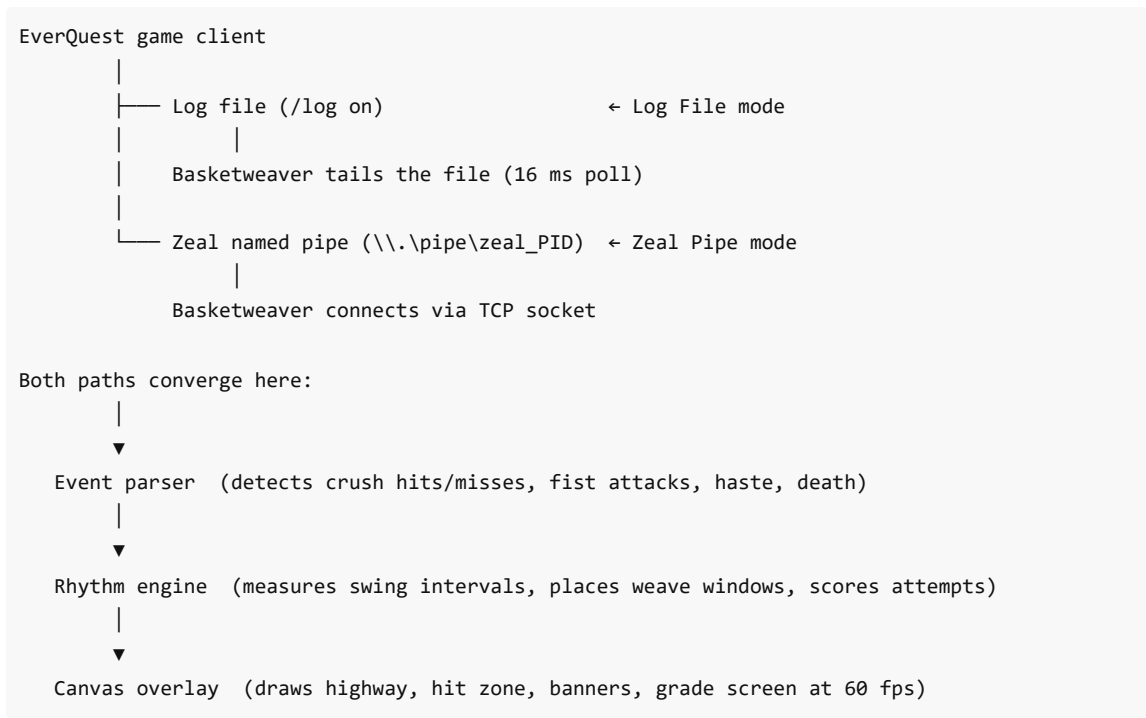
Basketweaver was designed with monks in mind but with additional development can scale to other classes.

What Basketweaver Does

Basketweaver watches every mainhand crush in real time and calculates exactly when your next swing will fire. It draws a scrolling **highway** overlay on top of EverQuest with a **green weave window** that shows the safe zone for your weapon swap. The window approaches a fixed **hit zone** at the left of the highway — when the window reaches the hit zone, swap to your offhand weapon set.

Every event is timestamped at the moment it arrives in the app, not when it was written to disk, which keeps the overlay accurate even during log-flush delays.

The Tracking Pipeline



Interval Measurement & Auto-Calibration

Basketweaver does not rely solely on your configured weapon delay. After each mainhand crush, it measures the actual elapsed time since the previous crush and maintains a rolling median of the last 6 measurements. When the measured median drifts more than 50 ms from the current interval, the overlay silently adjusts and shows a brief **Auto-calibrated** banner.

Calibration samples are filtered: any gap larger than 130% of the unhasted weapon delay is discarded as a skipped swing (out of range, interrupted, etc.) and does not pollute the median.

Grading

At the end of each fight, Basketweaver grades your performance based on the fraction of mainhand rounds in which you made a fist weave attempt. By default grading uses log-detected fist events. If you prefer to grade by keystrokes (so proc failures and dual-wield misses do not penalise you), enable **Keystroke Grading** in the tray menu.

Grade	Rounds weaved
S	≥ 95%
A	≥ 85%
B	≥ 75%
C	≥ 60%
D	≥ 45%
F	< 45%

2. Core Concepts & Definitions

Swing timer Each weapon in EQ operates on an independent internal countdown. When auto-attack is on, the timer counts down and fires the weapon, then resets to the weapon's delay and counts down again. The timer only runs while auto-attack is active and you have a valid target in range.

Weapon delay EQ stores weapon delays in tenths of a second (e.g. delay 20 = 2.0 s). Basketweaver uses this value as the baseline for interval calculations. Set it via tray → **Mainhand Delay**.

Haste A percentage bonus that shortens effective weapon delays. At 40% haste, a 2.0 s weapon fires every $2.0 / 1.40 = 1.43$ s. The EQ client cap is **125% haste**, giving a minimum effective delay of $\text{base} / 2.25$. Basketweaver tracks your haste via `/mystats` output and adjusts the highway speed accordingly.

Mainhand interval The time between consecutive mainhand swings at your current haste level:

```
interval = base_delay_seconds / (1 + haste_pct / 100)
```

Example: 2.0 s staff at 60% haste → $2.0 / 1.60 = 1.25$ s interval.

Offhand / fist weapon delay The delay of your secondary (fist) weapon, also haste-adjusted. This determines how long the fist timer needs to count down before firing. A shorter fist delay means a narrower safe weave window. Set via tray → **Offhand Delay** or set via tray → **Offhand Delay**.

Weave window The safe period between mainhand swings during which the fist weapon can fire without delaying the next mainhand. Duration:

```
window = mainhand_interval - fist_delay_seconds
```

Example: 1.25 s interval, 0.71 s fist delay → $1.25 - 0.71 = 0.54$ s window. This is drawn as the **green box** on the highway. A shorter window means tighter timing is required.

Clip A clip occurs when you initiate a fist weave too late — after the mainhand timer has already reset for its next swing. Your fist timer fires into the mainhand window, resetting the mainhand timer and delaying the next crush. Basketweaver flags clips with a red flash, an error sound, and a **CLIPPED** banner. Clipping is worse than skipping a weave because it actively delays mainhand damage.

Hit zone The vertical bar on the left side of the highway that acts as the timing target. Weave actions are judged at this point. When the green window reaches the hit zone, swap to your offhand weapon set. The hit zone position can be moved left or right via tray → **Target Position** (cosmetic only — timing is not affected).

Target offset A timing correction applied to the hit zone, in milliseconds. A positive offset makes the window appear to arrive at the hit zone slightly later, giving you more reaction time. Adjust if you consistently feel the window is arriving too early.

Latency compensation Fist attack events (punches) that arrive in the log or pipe after a network delay would be scored against the wrong window position. Latency compensation shifts the scoring timestamp backward by the configured amount so the hit is judged at the correct point on the highway. Typical values: 25–75 ms.

Round A complete mainhand swing cycle — from one crush (or miss) to the next. Basketweaver clusters rapid successive mainhand events within a 500 ms window into the same round to handle dual-wield proc firings.

Reaction time The delay between your mainhand crush landing and your first fist attempt in that round. Shown as **avg reaction** on the grade screen. Lower is better — ideally under 200 ms.

Out of range (OOR) When you are too far from your target to swing, EQ blocks the attack. Basketweaver detects OOR messages, plays a brief two-tone alert, and pauses the swing timer prediction (since the mainhand timer is frozen while OOR).

Cursor blocked EQ refuses weapon swaps when you are holding an item on your cursor. Basketweaver detects this and shows a **CURSOR!** banner so you know to clear your cursor before the next weave window.

Keystroke grading An alternate grading mode that counts space-bar or mouse-click presses that land inside a weave window instead of counting log-detected fist events. Useful when your fist attack has a proc component that sometimes fails silently, which would otherwise count as a missed weave under log-based grading.

3. First-Time Setup

Launch

Double-click **Basketweaver** from the Start Menu or desktop shortcut. On first launch a file picker will open automatically.

Select Your Log File

Navigate to your EverQuest folder and select your character's log file:

```
C:\TAKP\TAKPv22\eqlog_YourName_server.txt
```

Make sure EverQuest has logging enabled. In-game command: `/Log on`

Basketweaver remembers your log file and window position between sessions. Your character name is read from the log filename and displayed in the header. If the overlay ever ends up off-screen, use tray → **Reset Window Position** to snap it back to the center of your primary monitor.

Set Your Mainhand Weapon

Right-click the tray icon → **Mainhand Delay** → select your weapon.

Weapon	Delay
Imbued Fighter's Staff	4.0s
Ton Po's Bo Stick of Understanding	4.0s
Bo Staff of Trorsmang	3.5s
Abashi's Rod of Disillusionment	3.0s
Caen's Bo Staff of Fury	3.0s
Tranquil Staff	3.0s

Set Your Offhand (Fist) Weapon Delay

Right-click the tray icon → **Offhand Delay** → select the delay that matches your fist weapon. Default is 1.6s (delay 16 — standard monk fists).

Tip: Use the `/mystats` calibration macro to auto-detect this. See [Section 8](#).

4. Zeal Pipe Tracking

Zeal is a client plugin for EverQuest (TAKP / Project Quarm and similar servers) that exposes real-time game data through Windows named pipes. When Zeal is running alongside EQ, Basketweaver can read combat messages directly from the game process instead of parsing the log file.

Why Use Zeal Pipe Instead of the Log?

	Log File	Zeal Pipe
Latency	Bounded by how often EQ flushes the log to disk	Near-instant — events arrive as they fire in-game
Setup	Requires logging on (/log on)	No log file needed
Log required?	Yes	No
Auto-connects	No — you select a file	Yes — detects EQ automatically
Multiple EQ sessions	One log file at a time	Connects to all running EQ processes

Requirements

- The **Zeal plugin** must be installed and loaded in EverQuest. Zeal creates a named pipe (\\.\pipe\zeal_<PID>) for each running EQ process automatically — no extra configuration is needed.
- Basketweaver and EverQuest must be running on the same machine.

Enabling Zeal Pipe Tracking

Right-click the tray icon → **Tracking Source** → **Zeal Pipe**.

Basketweaver immediately stops tailing any open log file and begins scanning for `eqgame.exe` processes every 2 seconds. Once it finds one, it connects to the Zeal pipe and starts receiving events. A log entry appears in the console confirming the connection:

```
[ZealReader] Connected to pipe for PID 12345
```

The overlay behaves identically to log-based mode — swing detection, haste sync, weapon detection, and `/mystats` calibration all work the same way because the text content coming through the pipe is the same combat text that would appear in your log file.

Switching Back to Log Tracking

Right-click the tray icon → **Tracking Source** → **Log File (default)**.

If you had a log file selected before switching to Zeal, Basketweaver resumes tailing it automatically. If not, it will wait for you to select one via tray → **Select Log File....**

How It Works (technical)

Zeal writes JSON messages to its named pipe in the format:

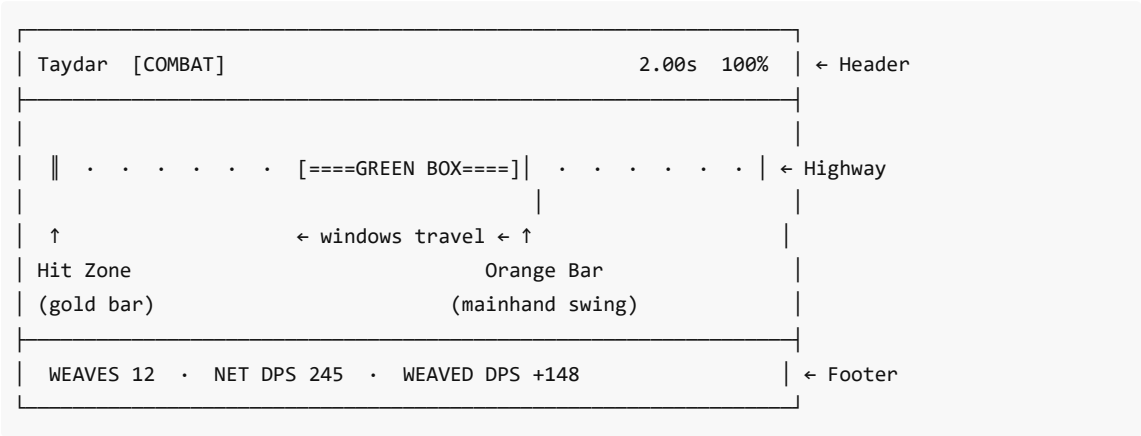
```
{"type": 0, "character": "Yourname", "data": "{\"type\": 265, \"text\": \"You crush a goblin for 42 points of damage.\"}"}
```

The outer `type` field is the message category (`0` = log text, `2` = gauges, `3` = labels, etc.). Basketweaver only processes log text messages. The inner `type` field is EverQuest's internal channel code, and `text` is the combat line — identical to what would be written to your log file, but without the `[Day Mon DD HH:MM:SS YYYY]` timestamp prefix.

Basketweaver applies the same pattern matching it uses for log parsing, so mainhand crush events, fist attacks, out-of-range messages, target deaths, and `/mystats` calibration output are all detected exactly as they are in log mode.

5. Understanding the Overlay

The overlay is a scrolling "highway" that sits on top of EverQuest. Weave windows approach from the right and travel left toward the hit zone. The default style is **Refined**; two alternate styles are available via tray → **Overlay Style**.



Elements

|| **Hit Zone** (gold vertical bar, left side) This is your timing target. Weave actions are judged here.

[===GREEN BOX===] (green rectangle) The safe weave window. This is the time between your mainhand swings during which it is safe to initiate a fist weave. Width = `mainhand interval - fist weapon delay`. Swap weapons while this box is at the hit zone.

| **Orange Bar** (thin vertical line at left edge of green box) Marks the exact moment your mainhand will swing next. When the orange bar reaches the hit zone, your mainhand fires. Do **not** initiate a weave after this point — you won't have time before the next swing.

CURSOR! warning If you try to swap weapons while holding an item on your cursor, EQ will block the swap. Basketweaver detects this, shows a **CURSOR!** banner, and plays an error sound so you know to clear your cursor immediately.

Footer Stats

Stat	Description
WEAVES	Number of mainhand rounds where a fist weave was attempted
NET DPS	Total melee DPS for the fight (mainhand + fist + procs)
WEAVED DPS	DPS contributed specifically by fist weave attacks

Overlay Styles

Three visual styles are available via tray → **Overlay Style:**

Style	Description
Refined (default)	Dark arcade look — gold bar hit zone, green weave windows, subtle grid
Standard	Original design — blue dot notes, circular hit zone, swing bar
High Contrast	Black background, vivid yellow/cyan colors — good for streaming or low-vision use

6. Timing Your Weaves

The Core Loop

Time flows this way →→→→→→→→
Windows scroll this way ←←←←

PAST	Hit Zone	Highway	FUTURE
------	----------	---------	--------

Step 1: Green box approaching hit zone

. . . || [====GREEN====] |

Step 2: GREEN BOX IS AT HIT ZONE — SWAP TO OFFHAND WEAPON SET NOW ✓

. . . [=||=====] |

Step 3: Orange bar arrives — mainhand swings, window closes

. || . . . [====GREEN====] | . .

What Good Timing Looks Like

When your fist punch lands inside the green window, the hit zone flashes gold and you hear the punch sound.

What a Miss Looks Like

If the weave window passes without a fist attack, a small "— **missed**" chip appears near the hit zone and fades out.

What a Clip Looks Like

If your fist attack lands outside the weave window (you swung through a window you already passed), a **red wash** floods the highway, the hit zone strobes red, and **CLIPPED** appears in red text. A harsh error sound plays. This means your offhand fired at the wrong time and may have clipped your mainhand swing timer.

End-of-Fight Grade Screen

The grade screen fires when your target dies or when you die. It shows your performance for that fight:

S	18/21 rounds weaved	← Grade + rounds with a weave
	net 312 dps	← Total melee DPS
	+148 dps from weaving	← Added DPS from fist weaves

142 ms avg reaction

← Crush → fist delay, per round

- **Grade** is based on what fraction of mainhand rounds had a fist weave attempt.
- **Net DPS** is your total melee damage output divided by fight duration.
- **+N dps from weaving** is the DPS contribution from fist attacks alone.
- **Avg reaction** is the average time from your mainhand crush to the first fist attack in that round — measured per round, one sample per round.

Press **Space** to dismiss.

Fight History (Standard style only)

When using the **Standard** overlay style, fight results are tracked and sent to the tray. Open tray → **Recent Fights** to view the last 5 results. Click any entry to copy it to the clipboard — useful for sharing parse results in Discord or guild chat.

7. Calibration

Automatic Haste Sync

Basketweaver watches for haste information in your log. When your server reports your haste percentage (via `/mystats` or a spell landing), it automatically recalculates the interval and adjusts the highway speed.

After a haste sync you will see a banner:

Haste sync: 1.25s (60% haste)

No manual action needed.

Manual Interval Adjustment

If auto-sync hasn't fired yet (e.g. at the start of a session), you can set the interval manually:

Right-click tray icon → **Interval** → select the seconds value that matches your current haste.

You can also use the arrow keys while the overlay is focused:

- **↑** — increase interval by 0.25s
- **↓** — decrease interval by 0.25s

If Weaves Feel Early (green box arrives too soon)

Increase **Target Offset** (shifts the hit zone timing later):

Right-click tray → **Target Offset** → try 25 ms, 50 ms steps

Or with the keyboard (Standard style only): **]** — add 25 ms offset **[** — remove 25 ms offset

If Weaves Feel Late (you're always catching the tail of the green box)

Decrease Target Offset back toward 0, or adjust **Latency Comp.** if your network adds delay between when you act and when EQ registers it:

Right-click tray → **Latency Comp.** → try 25–75 ms

Keyboard (Standard style only): ⌘ — add 25 ms latency comp ⌘ — remove 25 ms latency comp

Calibration Quick Reference

Symptom	Fix
Green box arrives too early, weaves clip	Increase Latency Comp.
Green box arrives too late, mainhand delays	Decrease Latency Comp.
Notes never reach hit zone	Check your log file is updating (logging on?)
Windows don't appear	Enter combat — windows only show during active fighting
Interval wrong after buff / zone	Use ↑ / ↓ keys or set Interval in tray

8. Tray Menu Reference

Right-click the Basketweaver icon in the system tray to open the menu.

Option	Description
Status	Shows IN COMBAT or IDLE (read-only)
Select Log File...	Choose a different EQ log file
Reset Track	Hard reset — clears all state if overlay gets out of sync
Recent Fights	Last 5 fight results; click any entry to copy it to clipboard
Target Position	Move the hit zone left or right on the highway
Reset Window Position	Snap overlay to a safe central position on the primary monitor
Mainhand Delay	Select your mainhand weapon from the preset list
Offhand Delay	Set your fist weapon delay manually
Interval	Override the post-haste swing interval
Target Offset	Fine-tune hit zone timing (ms)
Latency Comp.	Compensate for network/input delay (ms)
Clip Window	How long after a weave to suppress duplicate detections
Audio	Toggle all sounds on / off
Orientation	Switch between horizontal and vertical highway layouts
Overlay Style	Choose Refined (default), Standard, or High Contrast
Lane Lines	Show or hide the outer lane dividers on the highway
Fist Sound on Miss	Play a whiff sound when a round's swings all miss
Keystroke Grading	Grade weaves by keystrokes rather than log-detected fist attacks

Opacity	Overlay transparency (50% / 70% / 85% / 100%)
Tracking Source	Switch between Log File (default) and Zeal Pipe event tracking
Quit Basketweaver	Exit the app

Note: Changing **Overlay Style** reloads the renderer. Your log file reconnects automatically; other settings are preserved.

9. Keyboard Shortcuts

These work when the Basketweaver window is in focus (click it once).

All Styles

Key	Action
↑ / ↓	Interval +0.25s / -0.25s
H	Toggle orientation (horizontal ↔ vertical)
R	Reset track (same as tray Reset Track)
M	Toggle audio mute
Space	Dismiss grade screen
Escape	Quit

Standard Style Only

Key	Action
] / [	Target Offset +25ms / -25ms
' / ;	Latency Comp. +25ms / -25ms
, / .	Shift hit zone visually left / right (no timing effect)
v	Copy fight history to clipboard

10. Troubleshooting

Overlay doesn't show weave windows Weave windows only appear once you enter combat. Make sure logging is enabled (`/log on`) and the correct log file is selected. The header shows IDLE when no combat is detected.

Interval seems wrong after zoning or getting a haste buff Press `↑` or `↓` to nudge the interval, or run `/mystats` to let Basketweaver re-sync automatically.

Weaves land but are consistently late/early by the same amount Use **Target Offset** or **Latency Comp.** in the tray menu. Start with 25 ms steps and adjust until the hit zone flashes gold reliably at the moment you click swap.

The track gets out of sync mid-fight Press `R` or use tray → **Reset Track** to hard-reset the engine without closing the app.

Grade screen doesn't appear after a kill The grade screen fires when your current target dies — either `You have slain TARGET` or `TARGET has been slain by X` — provided you attacked that target within the last 10 seconds. It also fires when you die. Zone and logout end combat silently with no grade screen.

Out-of-range alert sound keeps playing The two-tone blip plays at most once every 1.5 seconds while you are in combat and out of range. It stops as soon as your mainhand connects again. If it fires outside of combat, check that your `COMBAT_END` patterns match your server's death/zone messages.

Audio not playing Click the overlay window once to focus it, then press `M` to toggle audio. You can also toggle via tray → **Audio**.

App asks for a log file every time If the previously saved log file is deleted or moved, the picker will open on launch. Select the new path and it will be remembered. If you use Zeal Pipe mode, no log file is needed — switch via tray → **Tracking Source** → **Zeal Pipe** and the prompt will not appear on subsequent launches.

Zeal Pipe mode shows no events

- Confirm Zeal is loaded in EverQuest (`/zeal` should respond in-game).
- Both Basketweaver and EQ must be running on the same machine — pipes are local-only.
- Basketweaver scans for `eqgame.exe` every 2 seconds after switching to Zeal mode. If EQ was started after Basketweaver, wait a moment or use tray → **Reset Track** to nudge the connection attempt.
- If EQ crashes or exits, Basketweaver detects the pipe closing and will reconnect automatically when EQ relaunches.

Switched to Zeal Pipe but weave windows stopped The Zeal plugin must be actively loaded. If you zoned or camped and Zeal unloaded, it will stop sending pipe data. Reload Zeal in-game and Basketweaver will reconnect within 2 seconds.

Recent Fights submenu always shows "No fights recorded yet" Fight history tracking is only active when using the **Standard** overlay style. Switch to Standard via tray → **Overlay Style** if you need the fight history submenu populated.

Basketweaver — designed with monks in mind, built to scale.